

CUDDLES CHILDMINDERS AND SCHOOLS
2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION
HOME–SCHOOL PARTNERSHIP AND EXPECTATIONS (RECEPTION)



Dear Parent/Guardian,

Welcome to another exciting academic session at **Cuddles Childminders and Schools**

Reception is an important stage in your child's early educational journey. At this level, children are encouraged to move from primarily exploratory learning towards more purposeful participation in classroom routines, communication, early numeracy, fine-motor development and independence.

Our aim is to provide a **safe, nurturing and stimulating environment** where every child can develop confidence, curiosity, social awareness and a positive attitude towards learning.

At Cuddles, we believe that children thrive when **home and school work together with consistency, clear expectations and mutual respect.**

OUR SHARED COMMITMENT

We believe:

- Every child is **unique** and deserves to be understood and supported.
- Strong **home–school partnerships** promote children's overall development.
- Young children learn best through **play, exploration, repetition and hands-on experiences.**
- Independence should be intentionally encouraged and developed.
- Clear routines and consistent expectations help children feel secure.
- Early academic skills should develop alongside **social, emotional, physical and practical skills.**

We invite you to partner with us as we support your child towards the following developmental goals and more.

RECEPTION DEVELOPMENTAL EXPECTATIONS

1. EARLY COGNITIVE & NUMERACY SKILLS

Your child will be supported to:

- Count objects sequentially from **0–30**.
- Recognise numbers **0–10**.
- Identify, describe and represent numbers **0–5**.
- Begin to connect numbers with corresponding quantities.
- Recognise and identify basic shapes.
- Identify and name primary colours.
- Sort and match objects by colour, shape, size or type.
- Identify simple similarities and differences.
- Recognise basic patterns and participate in simple sequencing activities.
- Name common household, school and outdoor objects.
- Identify at least **8 domestic animals** and **10 common fruits**.
- Identify external body parts and describe their basic uses.
- Demonstrate an awareness of basic hygiene and healthy habits.
- Participate in simple problem-solving, construction and matching activities.
- Build structures using **6 or more blocks**.

2. EARLY LANGUAGE & COMMUNICATION

Your child will be supported to:

- Listen attentively during stories, songs and classroom discussions.
- Respond appropriately to simple questions.
- Name familiar people, objects, animals and places.
- Use simple sentences to communicate needs, ideas and experiences.

- Develop a functional vocabulary of approximately **70 words**, appropriate to the child's developmental level.
- Identify and use selected opposite words appropriately.
- Demonstrate understanding of simple instructions.
- Retell very simple stories or familiar events.
- Participate actively in songs, rhymes and oral language activities.
- Memorise and confidently recite at least **10 age-appropriate nursery rhymes**.
- Begin to recognise familiar sounds, words and environmental print.

Good Manners & Social Language

Children will be introduced to the appropriate use of the **five magic words**:

Please • Thank You • Sorry • Excuse Me • Pardon Me

Parents are encouraged to reinforce these words naturally at home rather than requiring children to repeat them mechanically.

3. FINE-MOTOR & PRE-WRITING DEVELOPMENT

Your child will develop:

- Opportunities to draw and make marks on **sand, slates and paper**.
- Improved hand-eye coordination.
- Fine-motor strength through stacking, threading, moulding, tearing and other manipulative activities.
- Creativity through drawing, colouring, construction, music and movement.

4. PHYSICAL, SOCIAL & EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Children will be supported to:

- Develop gross-motor coordination through age-appropriate movement and outdoor play.
- Demonstrate at least **15 basic body actions through gestures and movement**.

- Follow simple classroom routines.
- Participate appropriately in group activities.
- Begin to share, take turns and interact positively with peers.
- Recognise and express basic emotions.
- Follow simple one- and two-step instructions.
- Develop confidence in communicating with familiar adults.
- Begin to manage simple frustrations with appropriate adult support.
- Develop positive relationships with teachers and classmates.

□ 5. SELF-HELP & INDEPENDENCE

Your child will gradually be encouraged to:

- Use the bathroom with minimal assistance, according to developmental readiness.
- Feed themselves with minimal assistance.
- Put on and remove shoes independently.
- Ask for help appropriately when needed.
- Pack away toys and learning materials.
- Begin taking responsibility for personal belongings.
- Participate in cleaning up after meals and activities.
- Attempt simple tasks independently before seeking assistance.
- Complete simple home-learning activities with limited support.

A NOTE TO PARENTS

Please allow your child to **try before you help**.

A child who struggles to put on a shoe, pack a bag, hold a pencil or clean up after an activity is not necessarily failing—the child is **learning independence**.

Give them time, encouragement and appropriate guidance.

SCHOOL HOURS & CARE ARRANGEMENTS

Extended Care

School/Childcare Opens: 7:00 a.m.

Regular Classes Close: 3:15 p.m.

Extended Care Closes: 5:00 p.m.

A **15-minute grace period** applies after 5:00 p.m. Thereafter, a **¥1,000 per hour late pick-up charge** applies.

Parents should make reliable arrangements for the timely collection of children.

School will operate according to the published academic calendar, except where closure is required because of public holidays, scheduled breaks, emergencies, government directives or circumstances affecting the health and safety of the school community.

MEALS & DAILY REQUIREMENTS

Parents should provide:

- Nutritious meals according to the school's meal guidance.
- Fresh fruit where required.
- A labelled water bottle.
- Personal cutlery.
- A suitable plate/container as requested.
- A medium-sized school bag.
- A complete change of clothes.
- Diapers, where still required.
- Any additional items specifically requested by the school.

Healthy Eating

We encourage nutritious, balanced meals and discourage excessive consumption of highly processed foods and sugary drinks.

Parents should avoid sending noodles, candy, juice, cookies, biscuits and other highly processed snacks unless specifically requested or permitted by the school.

Breakfast

Children should have a **proper breakfast before arriving at school**.

PERSONAL BELONGINGS

Please ensure that **every item brought to school is clearly labelled with your child's full name**.

The school will take reasonable care of children's belongings; however, the school cannot guarantee replacement of items that are lost, misplaced or mixed up.

ITEMS NOT PERMITTED

Unless specifically requested by the school, children should not bring:

- Toys from home
- Candy or sweets
- Chewing gum
- Juice or sugary drinks
- Cookies or biscuits
- Money
- Unauthorised food or personal items

These restrictions help maintain a **safe, healthy and distraction-free learning environment**.

HAIR & GROOMING

Children should arrive clean, neat and appropriately groomed.

Girls should wear simple, practical braids or plaits.

Beads and rubber rings are not permitted because of safety considerations.

HOMEWORK & PROJECTS

Homework

At Reception level, home-learning activities should be brief, simple and purposeful.

- Approximately **5 minutes of homework** may initially be assigned every other day.
- Activities will increase gradually as children become more ready.
- Homework may contribute to continuous assessment.
- Parents should encourage and guide but should not complete the work for the child.

Projects

Both individual and group projects may form part of the learning programme.

- Participation is **compulsory**.
- Projects may be assessed and graded.
- Parents may provide requested materials and reasonable guidance.
- The child's participation should remain central to the project.

The purpose of a project is to develop the child—not to showcase the parent's skills.

HEALTH, WELLNESS & SAFETY

The health and safety of our learners and staff is a shared responsibility.

Please keep your child at home when they are visibly unwell or experiencing symptoms of a contagious illness.

Please keep your child at home if they have:

- A fever of **38°C or above**.
- Repeated vomiting or diarrhoea.
- Chickenpox, measles or another contagious illness.
- Conjunctivitis (pink eye).
- Impetigo or draining/open sores.

- A concerning or unexplained skin rash.
- A persistent or severe cough that prevents normal participation.
- Significant pain or visible illness.
- An injury or condition requiring care beyond what the school can safely provide.
- Significant emotional distress that prevents safe participation.
- Burns or injuries requiring medical attention.

Where a child becomes unwell or sustains an injury at school, appropriate first aid will be provided and the parent or authorised emergency contact will be notified where necessary.

A child may be moved to a **supervised Recovery Bay** while awaiting collection.

Parents are expected to make **prompt arrangements for collection** when contacted.

Returning to School

Children should return when they have sufficiently recovered and are able to participate safely and comfortably in normal school activities.

Where appropriate, the school may request medical clearance following a prolonged illness, contagious condition or significant health concern.

MEDICATION

Medication will only be administered in accordance with the school's medication procedures.

All medication must:

- Be clearly labelled with the child's name.
- Be accompanied by appropriate parental authorisation and instructions.
- Be submitted through the school's approved process.
- Be appropriately documented.

Medication should never be left in a child's school bag for unsupervised use.

□ HEALTH & HYGIENE

Parents are encouraged to reinforce good hygiene practices at home:

- Regular handwashing.
- Proper toilet hygiene.
- Brushing teeth.
- Regular bathing.
- Covering the mouth and nose when coughing or sneezing.
- Proper disposal of tissues and waste.
- Keeping personal belongings clean.
- Informing an adult when they feel unwell.

FEES & SCHOOL RESPONSIBILITIES

- School fees must be paid within the stipulated payment period.
- Outstanding fees may result in suspension of access to school services in accordance with school policy.
- Parents may be held responsible for deliberate or negligent damage to school property caused by their child.
- Children should be taught to respect school property, learning materials and the belongings of others.

STAFF APPRECIATION

To maintain professionalism, fairness and appropriate boundaries, parents are discouraged from giving staff members **cash gifts or personal financial incentives**.

Verbal appreciation, written feedback and formal recognition are always welcome.

WORKING TOGETHER

Your involvement matters.

We encourage parents to participate actively in:

- Parent–teacher conferences.

- Emergency communication and response.
- Parent engagement activities.
- **Involved Parent Days.**
- School events and learning activities.
- Home-learning reinforcement.

Parents are also expected to keep the school informed of significant changes that may affect their child's **health, wellbeing, behaviour, development or ability to participate fully in school activities.**

HOW YOU CAN SUPPORT YOUR CHILD AT HOME

You can strengthen your child's learning through simple everyday experiences:

- Read picture books together.
- Sing songs and recite nursery rhymes.
- Count toys, fruits, steps and household objects.
- Identify colours and shapes around the home.
- Practise simple opposite words.
- Encourage your child to name body parts and objects.
- Ask questions about stories and daily experiences.
- Encourage polite language and the use of the five magic words.
- Allow your child to dress, feed and tidy up independently where possible.
- Provide opportunities for drawing, colouring, building and sorting.
- Praise effort, independence and responsible behaviour.

Small moments create big foundations.

Talk to your child.

Read with your child.

Play with your child.

Let your child try.

Celebrate their progress.

OUR SHARED GOAL

Our goal at Reception is to nurture a child who is increasingly:

**CURIOUS • CONFIDENT • COMMUNICATIVE • INDEPENDENT • CREATIVE • KIND •
READY TO LEARN**

Together, we can provide the consistency, encouragement and opportunities children need to develop strong foundations for the next stage of their educational journey.

Thank you for entrusting **Cuddles Childminders and Schools** with your child's care, development and education.

We look forward to a safe, purposeful, joyful and rewarding academic year together.

Warm regards,

Mrs. Bukola Odomo
Head of School
Cuddles Childminders and Schools